

I've heard that digital currency requires massive energy use to manage. But won't AI and quantum computing, which are now upon us, also require massive energy use and be bad for the planet?

Posted by u/georgewalterackerman • 0 points • 1 comments

How much of a negative impact on the environment will be brought about by AI and quantum computing?

Comments

u/radicalceleryjuice • 3 points • 2024-04-10 16:22 UTC

They are building AI data centres at dizzying speeds. Here's an article to get started:

<https://www.thestreet.com/technology/ai-electricity-requirements>

Based on that article and other recent trends, I'm guessing next year AI will account for 3-5% of global electricity use... but that's very napkin-math.

It's worth looking into other major uses of electricity, just to get a sense of things. For instance, in the USA air-conditioning accounts for 19% of electricity: <https://www.eia.gov/tools/faqs/faq.php?id=1174&t=1#:~:text=According%20to%20the%20most%20recent,electricity%20consumption%20in%20U.S.%20homes.>

...meanwhile, some of that AI may get used to improve energy efficiency and grid-management and other things we need.

But basically, yes, AI is now a major and quickly growing end-use of energy.